



CHEF

JOB DESCRIPTION

A love of food and cooking is vital to succeed as a chef. The role involves planning and coordinating food production at a restaurant or other eatery, managing a kitchen, and instructing waitstaff. Chefs may cook food themselves or oversee its preparation by their staff. Many chefs are known to create unique menus and signature dishes. They also handle buying and budgeting for catering operations and restaurants.



SALARY

Commis chef ★★★★★

Head chef ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Most restaurants run independently to tight budgets • Worldwide job opportunities • Industry constantly adapting to changing culinary tastes

CAREER PATHS

Most chefs train on the job, joining a kitchen as a trainee, or *commis chef*, and studying for vocational qualifications. Ability and commitment are your keys to promotion. Working under a rated chef can give your career an extra boost.

TRAINEE Following school, trainees learn their craft by rotating through sections such as vegetables, fish, and butchery to become familiar with them all. The type and length of apprenticeship depends on the employer.

GRADUATE Private academies, some run by notable cooks, provide training for aspiring chefs. However, fees can be high, and there is no guarantee of employment later.

HEAD CHEF Devises a restaurant menu and runs its kitchen. The role also involves making key business decisions with the aim of making the establishment a success.



CHEF With experience and sufficient talent, you will climb the ladder of responsibility in the kitchen, through prep cook and line cook, to *sous chef* (the second-in-command, who may schedule staff and buy ingredients), to the position of head chef, or *chef de cuisine*.